

CLEMATIS

Old man's beard, Travellers' joy

RANUNCULACEAE

Genus of evergreen or deciduous, mainly twining climbers and herbaceous perennials, cultivated for their abundant flowers, often followed by decorative seed heads, and grown on walls and trellises and together with trees, shrubs and other host plants. Only early-flowering species are evergreen, although some later-flowering species are semievergreen. Most species have nodding, bell-shaped flowers, with 4 petals (botanically known as perianth segments), or flattish flowers, each usually with 4–6 generally pointed petals. Large-flowered cultivars also bear flattish flowers, but with 4–10 petals. Flower color may vary according to climatic conditions: in general, the warmer the climate, the darker the flower color. May be grown in partial shade or full sun, but prefers rich, well-drained soil with roots shaded. Propagate cultivars in early summer by softwood or semiripe cuttings or layering, species from seed sown in fall. Aphids, mildew and clematis wilt may cause problems.

Clematis may be divided into groups according to their flowering seasons, habit and pruning needs. See also feature panel pp.198–200.

Group 1

Early-flowering species and early small-flowered cultivars prefer a sheltered, sunny site with well-drained soil. Small, single flowers, either bell-shaped or open-bell-shaped, ¼–2in (2–5cm) long, or saucer-shaped, 1¼–2in (4–5cm) across, are borne on the previous season's ripened shoots in spring or, occasionally, in late winter. Leaves are evergreen and glossy, or deciduous, and usually divided into 3 lance-shaped, 5in (12cm) long leaflets or into 3 fernlike, 2in (5cm) long leaflets. **C. alpina**, **C. macropetala** and their cultivars tolerate cold, exposed positions. Small, bell-shaped to open bell-shaped, single, semidouble, or double flowers, 1¼–3in (3–7cm) across, are borne on the previous season's ripened shoots in spring, occasionally also on the current season's shoots in summer. Deciduous, pale to mid-green leaves are divided into 3–5 lance-shaped to broadly oblong, toothed leaflets, 1¼in (3cm) long.

C. montana and its cultivars are vigorous, deciduous climbers, suitable for growing over large buildings and trees. Small, flat to saucer-shaped, usually single flowers, 2–3in (5–7cm) across, are borne on the previous season's ripened shoots in late spring. Leaves are mid- to purplish-green and divided into 3 lance-shaped to broadly , serrated leaflets, 3in (8cm) long with pointed tips.

Prune all group 1 clematis after flowering to allow new growth to be produced and ripened for the following season. Remove dead or damaged stems and cut back other shoots that have outgrown their allotted space. This will encourage new growth to bear flowers in the following season.

Group 2

Early large-flowered cultivars

bearing mostly saucer-shaped, single, semidouble, or fully double flowers, 4–8in (10–20cm) across, that are borne on the previous season's ripened shoots, in late spring and early summer, and on new shoots in mid- and late summer. Generally the second flush of flowers on semidouble and double forms produces single flowers. Deciduous, pale to mid-green leaves are usually 4–6in (10–15cm) long and divided into 3 ovate or lance-shaped leaflets, or are simple and ovate, and to 4in (10cm) long.

Prune before new growth starts, in early spring. Remove dead or damaged stems and cut back all remaining shoots to where strong buds are visible. These buds provide a framework of second-year shoots which, in turn, produce sideshoots that flower in late spring and early summer. The flowers may then be removed. Young shoots bear more flowers later in the summer.

Group 3

Late large-flowered cultivars

producing outward-facing, usually saucer-shaped, single flowers, 3–6in (7–15cm) across, borne on new shoots in summer or early fall. Leaves are deciduous and similar to those of early cultivars (group 2), described above.

Late-flowering species and late small-flowered cultivars that bear small, single or double flowers on the current season's shoots in summer–fall. Flowers vary in shape and may be star-shaped, tubular, bell-shaped, flattish or resembling nodding lanterns; they vary in size from ½in (1cm) to 4in (10cm) across. Have generally deciduous, pale to dark green or gray-green leaves divided into 3 lance-shaped to broadly leaflets, each ½in (1cm) long, or hairy and/or toothed leaves divided into 5 or more lance-shaped to broadly leaflets, each ½–4in (1–10cm) long.

Herbaceous species and cultivars producing single flowers that are either saucer-shaped, ½–¾in (1–2cm) across, or bell-shaped or tubular, ½–1½in (1–4cm) long, and are produced on the current season's shoots in summer. Mid- to dark green or gray-green leaves are simple and lance-shaped to elliptic, 1–6in (2.5–15cm) long, or are divided into 3–5 lance-shaped to ovate, serrated leaflets, each 4–6in (10–15cm) long with a pointed tip.

Prune all group 3 clematis before new growth begins, in early spring. Cut back all the previous season's stems to a pair of strong buds, 6–8in (15–20cm) above soil level.

C. 'Abundance', syn. *C. viticella* 'Abundance' (illus. p.200). Late small-flowered clematis (group 3). H 6–10ft (2–3m), S 3ft (1m). Produces flattish, deep purplish-red flowers, 2in (5cm) across, with cream anthers, in summer. Z4–9
C. ALABAST ('Poulala'). Vigorous, long-flowering, large-flowered clematis (group 2). H 10ft (3m), S 3ft (1m). Freely produces creamy-green, rounded, large flowers 5–6in (12–15cm) across, with creamy-yellow anthers, in late spring and again from mid- to late summer. Z4–9

C. 'Alionushka' (illus. p.199).

Late, small-flowered clematis (group 3). H 3–4ft (1–1.2m), S 3ft (1m). In midsummer to early fall, produces single, rich mauvish-pink flowers, 2½–3in (6–8cm) across, with a satin sheen when young, with deep ridges on the reverse and crumpled edges; the petal tips recurve and twist as they age. Z4–9

C. alpina. Alpina clematis (group 1). H 6–10ft (2–3m), S 5ft (1.5m). Has lantern-shaped, single, blue flowers, 1½–3in (4–7cm) long, in spring and, occasionally, summer. Forms attractive, fluffy, silvery seed heads in summer. Ideal for a north-facing or very exposed site. Z4–9.

'Columbine' see C. 'Columbine'.

'Constance' see C. 'Constance'.

'Frances Ravis' see C. 'Frances Ravis'.

'Frankie' see C. 'Frankie'.

C. 'Andromeda' (illus. p.198). Early large-flowered clematis (group 2). H 6–10ft (2–3m), S 3ft (1m). Semidouble, white flowers, with bright pink stripes in the center of each sepal, are produced in spring. Blooms again, producing single flowers later in the year. Z4–9

C. ANGELIQUE ('Evip017'). Compact, early large-flowered clematis (group 2). H 3–4ft (90cm–1.2m), S 3ft (1m). Produces an abundance of lilac-blue, brown-anthered flowers, 4in (10cm) across, from early summer to late fall. Z4–9

C. ANNA LOUISE ('Evithee') (illus. p.200). Compact, early large-flowered clematis (group 2). H 3–4ft (1–1.2m), S 3ft (1m). Freely produces single flowers with violet petals with a contrasting red-purple central bar, and striking brown anthers, in late spring to early summer, and again in late summer to early fall. Z4–9

C. ARCTIC QUEEN ('Evitwo') (illus. p.198). Early large-flowered clematis (group 2). H 10ft (3m), S 3ft (1m). From early summer to early fall, freely produces double, clear creamy-white flowers, 4–7in (10–18cm) across, with yellow anthers. Z4–9

C. armandii (illus. p.198). Strong-growing, evergreen, early-flowering clematis (group 1). H 10–15ft (3–5m), S 6–10ft (2–3m). Bears scented, flattish, single, white flowers, 1½in (4cm) across, in early spring. Needs a sheltered, south- or south-west-facing site. Z8–10

C. 'Ascotiensis'. Vigorous, late large-flowered clematis (group 3). H 10–12ft (3–4m), S 3ft (1m). Single, bright violet-blue flowers, 3½–5in (9–12cm) across, with pointed petals and brownish-green anthers, are produced in summer. Z4–9

C. AVANT-GARDE ('Evip033') (illus. p.200). Vigorous, late small-flowered clematis (group 3). H 10ft (3m), S 3ft (1m). Produces deep red flowers to 2in (5cm) across, with central pompons of pink, petaloid stamens, in abundance from midsummer to fall. Z4–9

C. 'Barbara Dibley' (illus. p.199). Early large-flowered clematis (group 2). H 8ft (2.5m), S 3ft (1m). In late spring, produces single, petunia-red flowers, to 9in (23cm) across, with carmine-red to red-purple stripes along each sepal and red-purple stamens. Z4–9

C. 'Barbara Jackman' (illus. p.199). Early large-flowered clematis (group 2). H to 10ft (3m), S 3ft (1m). In early summer, produces single, bluish-mauve flowers,

with crimson stripes and creamy-white stamens, followed in late summer by a further flush. Grow in semishade as flowers fade in full sun. Z4–9

C. 'Bees' Jubilee'. Compact, early large-flowered clematis (group 2). H 8ft (2.5m), S 3ft (1m). In early summer, bears a profusion of single, deep pink flowers, 4–5in (10–12cm) across, with brown anthers and a central, rose-madder stripe on each petal. Prefers partial shade. Z4–9

C. 'Betty Corning' (illus. p.200). Late small-flowered clematis (group 3). H to 13ft (4m), S 3ft (1m). Slightly scented, bell-shaped, lilac to pinkish-mauve flowers, 1½–2½in (4–6cm) across, are borne from early summer to early fall. Z4–9

C. 'Bill MacKenzie'. Vigorous, late small-flowered clematis (group 3). H 22ft (7m), S 10–12ft (3–4m). Has dark green leaves and yellow flowers, 2½–3in (6–7cm) across. Best pruned with shears. Z4–9

C. 'Black Prince' (illus. p.200). Late small-flowered clematis (group 3). H to 13ft (4m), S 3ft (1m). In midsummer, produces bell-shaped, seminodding, very dark blackish-claret-red flowers, to 3½in (9cm) across, with maroon stamens. Z4–9
C. BLUE MOON ('Evirin'). See CLAIR DE LUNE ('Evirin').

C. BONANZA ('Evip031'). Vigorous, late small-flowered clematis (group 3). H 10ft (3m), S 3ft (1m). Produces blue-purple blooms to 3in (7cm) across, with pale yellow anthers, from midsummer to fall. Z4–9

C. BOURBON ('Evip018') (illus. p.200). Compact, early large-flowered clematis (group 2). H 4–6ft (1.2–2m), S 3ft (1m). Produces an abundance of vibrant, red, yellow-centered flowers, 3in (8cm) across, from early to midsummer. Z4–9

C. 'Broughton Star', syn. *C. montana* 'Broughton Star'. Vigorous Montana clematis (group 1). H 12–15ft (4–5m), S 6–10ft (2–3m). In late spring, bears semidouble to fully double, cup-shaped, dusty pink flowers, with slightly darker veins. Z5–9

C. 'Carnaby'. Compact, early large-flowered clematis (group 2). H 8ft (2.5m), S 3ft (1m). In early summer, bears a profusion of single, deep pink flowers, 3–4in (8–10cm) across, with a darker stripe on each petal and red anthers. Prefers partial shade. Z4–9

C. x cartmanii. Evergreen, clump-forming, bushy shrub (group 1) with some procumbent stems. H 8–10in (20–25cm). S 20in (50cm). Has dissected, leathery, shiny, dark green leaves varying in shape. Leafy panicles of shallowly cup-shaped, pure white flowers, ¾–1½in (2–4cm) across, with white anthers, are freely produced in early spring. Z6–10. **'Avalanche'** (illus. p.198), H and S 10–16ft (3–5m), has roughly ovate, deeply toothed leaves and white flowers flushed pale green at the base. **'Joe'** (illus. p.198), H to 6ft (2m), has 3-parted, toothed leaves; procumbent stems can be trained upward.

C. CASSIS ('Evip020'). Vigorous, long-flowering, late large-flowered clematis (group 3). H 6–10ft (2–3m). Produces fully double, plum red, rosetted flowers, 3in (8cm) across, borne from early summer to early fall. Z4–9

C. CEZANNE ('Evip023'). Compact, long-flowering, early large-flowered clematis